

Unit 4

Unit grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 80	64	56	48	40	32

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–31.

Qualification results

The minimum uniform marks required for each grade:

Advanced Subsidiary Cash-in code 8ET01

Qualification grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 200	160	140	120	100	80

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–79.

Advanced GCE Cash-in code 9ET01

Qualification grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 400	320	280	240	200	160

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–159.

Language of assessment

Assessment of this specification will be available in English only. Assessment materials will be published in English only and all work submitted for examination and moderation must be produced in English.

Quality of written communication

Students will be assessed on their ability to:

- write legibly, with accurate use of spelling, grammar and punctuation in order to make the meaning clear
- select and use a form and style of writing appropriate to purpose and to complex subject matter
- organise relevant information clearly and coherently, using specialist vocabulary when appropriate.

Students will be given the opportunity to demonstrate quality of written communication via AO1 in each of the four units.

Assessment objectives and weighting

		% in AS	% in A2	% in GCE
AO1	Articulate creative, informed and relevant responses to literary texts, using appropriate terminology and concepts, and coherent, accurate written expression	27.5%	22.5%	25%
AO2	Demonstrate detailed critical understanding in analysing the ways in which structure, form and language shape meanings in literary texts	25%	32.5%	28.75%
AO3	Explore connections and comparisons between different literary texts, informed by interpretations of other readers	32.5%	22.5%	27.5%
AO4	Demonstrate understanding of the significance and influence of the contexts in which literary texts are written and received	15%	22.5%	18.75%

Synoptic assessment

In synoptic assessment there should be a concentration on the quality of assessment to ensure that it encourages the development of the holistic understanding of the subject.

Synopticity requires students to connect knowledge, understanding and skills acquired in different parts of the Advanced GCE course.

Synoptic assessment in the context of English Literature requires students to apply the knowledge, skills and understanding gained from their studies to be applied to assessments in Units 3 and 4.

Stretch and challenge

Students can be stretched and challenged in A2 units through the use of different assessment strategies, for example:

- using a variety of stems in questions — for example analyse, evaluate, discuss, compare
- ensuring connectivity between sections of questions
- a requirement for extended writing
- use of a wider range of question types to address different skills — for example open-ended questions
- improvement of synoptic assessment.

Additional information

Malpractice and plagiarism

For up-to-date advice on malpractice and plagiarism, please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) — Suspected Malpractice in Examinations: Policies and Procedures document on the JCQ website www.jcq.org.uk/

Access arrangements and special requirements

Edexcel's policy on access arrangements and special considerations for GCE, GCSE and Entry Level aims to enhance access to the qualifications for learners with disabilities and other difficulties (as defined by the Disability Discrimination Act 1995 and the amendments to the Act) without compromising the assessment of skills, knowledge, understanding or competence.

Please see the Edexcel website (www.edexcel.org.uk/sfc) for:

- the JCQ policy Access Arrangements and Special Considerations, Regulations and Guidance Relating to Candidates who are Eligible for Adjustments in Examinations.
- the forms to submit for requests for access arrangements and special considerations
- dates for submission of the forms.

Requests for access arrangements and special considerations must be addressed to:

Special Requirements
Edexcel
One90 High Holborn
London WC1V 7BH

Disability Discrimination Act

Please see *Appendix 9* for the Advanced GCE in English Literature Disability Discrimination Act information.

Prior learning and progression

Prior learning

Students who would benefit most from studying a GCE in English Literature are likely to have a Level 2 qualification such as a GCSE in English at grades A*–C.

Progression

This qualification supports progression into higher education, training or employment, such as media, education, law, public and voluntary sectors.

Combinations of entry

Forbidden combinations are:

- any other Advanced Subsidiary or Advanced GCE qualification with the title 'English Literature' available at the same examination sitting
- Edexcel Advanced Subsidiary GCE or Advanced GCE English Language and Literature at the same examination sitting.

Student recruitment

Edexcel's access policy concerning recruitment to our qualifications is that:

- they must be available to anyone who is capable of reaching the required standard
- they must be free from barriers that restrict access and progression
- equal opportunities exist for all students.

Key skills

This qualification provides opportunities for developing and generating evidence for assessing the key skills listed below:

- communication
- information and communication technology
- improving own learning and performance
- working with others.

Further details are available in *Appendices 2 and 3*.

This qualification will be mapped to functional skills once they are finalised. Information will be available on our website (www.edexcel.org.uk/gce2008) at a later date.

The wider curriculum

This qualification provides opportunities for developing an understanding of spiritual, moral, ethical, social and cultural issues, together with an awareness of environmental issues, health and safety considerations, citizenship and European developments consistent with relevant international agreements appropriate as applied to English Literature. *Appendix 4: Wider curriculum maps the opportunities available.*

E Resources, support and training

Resources to support the specification

In addition to the resources available in the e-Spec and in the Getting Started and Internal Assessment Guide books, Edexcel produces a wide range of resources to support this specification.

Edexcel's own published resources

Edexcel aims to provide the most comprehensive support for our qualifications. We have therefore published our own dedicated suite of resources for teachers and students written by qualification experts. These resources include:

- AS Students' Book
- A2 Students' Book
- AS and A2 Teacher's CD ROM.

These materials are written by Senior Examiners and highly respected authors of GCE English Literature materials.

For more information on our complete range of products and services for GCE in English Literature, visit www.edexcel.org.uk/gce2008

Edexcel publications

You can order further copies of the specification and SAMs documents from:

Edexcel Publications
Adamsway
Mansfield
Notts NG18 4FN

Telephone: 01623 467467
Fax: 01623 450481
Email: publications@linneydirect.com
Website: www.edexcel.org.uk

Additional resources endorsed by Edexcel

Edexcel also endorse additional materials written to support this qualification. Any resources bearing the 'Endorsed by Edexcel' logo have been through a rigorous quality assurance process to ensure complete and accurate support for the specification. For up-to-date information about endorsed resources, please visit www.edexcel.org.uk/endorsed

Please note that, while resources are checked at the time of publication, materials may be withdrawn from circulation and website locations may be changed.

The resources listed are intended to be a guide for teachers and not a comprehensive list. Further suggestions can be found in *Appendix 8*.

Please see www.edexcel.org.uk/gce2008 for up to date information.

Support

Edexcel support services

Edexcel has a wide range of support services to help you implement this qualification successfully.

ResultsPlus — Resultsplus is a new application launched by Edexcel to help subject teachers, senior management teams, and students by providing detailed analysis of examination performance. Reports that compare performance between subjects, classes, your centre and similar centres can be generated in 'one-click'. Skills maps that show performance according to the specification topic being tested are available for some subjects. For further information about which subjects will be analysed through ResultsPlus, and information on how to access and use the service, please visit www.edexcel.org.uk/resultsplus

Ask the Expert – Ask the Expert is a new service, launched in 2007, that provides direct email access to senior subject specialists who will be able to answer any questions you might have about this or any qualification. All of our specialists are senior examiners, moderators or verifiers and they will answer your email personally. You can read a biography for all of them and learn more about this unique service on our website at www.edexcel.org.uk/asktheexpert.